



Issue #4: Brand New Venom

It's time to get back to the regularly scheduled Icebox, where I talk about what is relevant, what is ice-cold, or what is mine. What better way to start back up again than with the one and only, VENOM?

Recently, there has been quite a lot of news regarding Venom that I would like to share. I am feeling very optimistic about the future of this character, regardless of what everyone else thinks is going to happen.

After watching "Spider-Man: Brand New Day" I can tell you that the MCU Peter is absolutely ready to face otherworldly challenges on his own. This includes, of course, the symbiote suit. Spoilers ahead if you have not seen the movie!

Yes, the first thing to discuss about Venom is when he will finally debut in the MCU. The exact way it will be done is still unclear. There was that post-credit scene in "Venom: Let There Be Carnage" where the symbiote side of Venom seems to recall Peter Parker through the hivemind. Then, the post-credit scene in "Spider-Man: No Way Home" has our beloved Tom Hardy end up in the MCU for only a moment, but a piece of the symbiote gets left behind. It is possible that this piece of symbiote will find Peter.

However, the post-credit scene in "Brand New Day" shows that Peter, or Spider-Man being tracked through Ned Leeds's app, is off-world. This is very likely to reference "Avengers: Secret Wars" and that means Spider-Man is on another planet called Battleworld. In the comics, this is where Spidey acquires the symbiote suit.

Either way, the development Peter Parker has had in the latest film demonstrates that he is prepared for the symbiote era. He has perfected control over his heightened senses, gone fully organic, and doesn't pull his punches when applicable. In a way, "Brand New Day" was a preview of what Peter Parker's symbiote era will look like.

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Written by Master Freeze

There is also recent news about a new Venom movie entirely. However, this will be animated. According to writers, the film will be made by the same studio responsible for the Spiderverse movies. That is already an extremely promising outcome. It has also been confirmed that Tom Hardy will be involved in some way, just as I hoped.

Tom Hardy has done a magnificent job of managing a Venom trilogy which captures the heroic and goofy aspects of the character, and he accomplished it without needing to include Spider-Man. I really enjoyed his version of Eddie Brock, and I think bringing him into the MCU is only logical.

If you connect the dots so far, Tom Hardy's Venom will likely be launched through the multiverse somehow. It is entirely possible that the animated film ties into "Spider-Man: Beyond the Spiderverse" which has been rumoured to have our beloved symbiote in a part of the movie. If that is the case, then Tom Hardy's Venom might encounter Miles Morales even before ending up in the MCU.

If neither of those are the case, then the symbiote that ended up in the MCU at the end of "No Way Home" will find a new host, possibly Flash Thompson or the MCU's own Eddie Brock. This could mean either Agent Venom or a rebooted Venom character.

In terms of the film industry, there is one more major topic to address: Knull. The King in Black was shown to be the overarching threat in "Venom: The Last Dance" and implied to return some day. The ending of that film shows that the symbiote for Venom is still alive and in hiding, while Eddie is able to resume his life as a reporter. However, with all of the new projects revolving around Venom and the spotlight that Knull has received in the last two years, I believe the ultimate debut may be coming together.

Knull is the creator of the symbiotes and the god of the void itself. Before the celestials created the universe, there was nothing but darkness. That darkness was Knull himself, who awoke when the celestials tried to invade his domain with light. He slaughtered them and conquered domains with his own darkness with sheer power.

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Knull eventually created the symbiotes and their natural predators. He also has demon dragons for pets, but that is a whole different story. The symbiotes fell under Knull's control until Thor eventually freed them from the hivemind, which is another long story. The symbiotes created a prison for Knull, sealing him and his Necrosword on the planet Klyntar. The only way for Knull to escape is to acquire a codex from a perfectly bonded symbiote and its host, as also shown in the last Venom film.

The idea is that Knull is going to escape, and he will probably get involved in the MCU from there. This will only happen after the Dr. Doom arc. In my opinion, it makes sense that Knull can step in afterwards, as he is the looming threat and the celestials have already been involved in the MCU in a few places. However, the writing and development for such a villain may be difficult. The reason I am still optimistic is because Dr. Doom was only introduced to replace Kang the Conqueror after the character's runtime was cut short due to domestic abuse-related issues with the actor.

The discussion of what will happen in "Avengers: Doomsday" is a whole other conversation, but I do believe that Thor and Loki's involvement in the MCU is going to be important if the directors decide they want to go through with Knull. Another important thing to note is that Knull is technically owned by Sony, so a much larger degree of collaboration would be required. Again, I am optimistic after seeing the success of "Brand New Day" which was an excellent display of Sony's influence on the MCU.

There is still much more news about Venom outside of the movies. Recently, Venom has been rebooted as a comic. A brand-new first issue will be published in October of this year. The comic is written by Charles Soule who has written Daredevil and Star Wars comics in the past. The new comic will reunite Eddie and the symbiote to form the one true Venom, who will have the goal to be the best hero he can be. This is exciting news as Eddie has not been with the symbiote for quite some time and previous writers have been messing around with too many hosts and plot lines.

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Finally, Insomniac is working on a Venom video game. This studio has produced the famous Spider-Man games, which currently have three installments. At the end of "Spider-Man 2", the symbiote is eradicated from Earth after Peter and Miles destroy the meteorite from Klyntar and Peter purges the symbiote from his friend, Harry. At the end of the game, Peter still has an anti-Venom suit and the symbiote is supposedly gone forever. However, Venom never truly dies, so of course the symbiote will return.

My guess is that a piece of the symbiote will find Eddie Brock and that Spider-Man will be a temporary antagonist in the Venom game. However, it is also possible that the symbiote finds Flash Thompson and the game brings back Agent Venom, though this is much more unlikely due to Harry having been Agent Venom already. Personally, I never liked that Harry had the symbiote or that Insomniac decided to make the symbiote an invasive, all-encompassing alien rather than a nuisance.

Regardless, I am looking forward to the Venom video game and will also stay tuned for the new Venom comic releasing in October. These days, I only care about Spider-Man and Venom when discussing the MCU. I will carefully monitor how the next few films play out to see what other dots can be connected.

That is about the rundown of all the good news surrounding my favorite fictional character of all time. Thank you for reading this issue of the Icebox.

"We are Venom!"